Snippets

Airtel eyeing Telenor's India business

India's largest telco, Bharti Airtel, is evaluating the option of buying Telenor's India business. Bharti Airtel has valued the business at US$ 350 million, which is half of Telenor India's liabilities. The structure of the deal currently being discussed would entail Bharti Airtel taking over half of Telenor's liabilities worth US$ 700 million for upcoming spectrum payouts and payments for tower deals.

e-Wallets may soon have to insure customers' money

The government of India is looking to introduce insurance for transactions done through e-wallets, and it has held three meetings with insurers and mobile wallet companies in this regard. Through new regulations, the government hopes to make it mandatory for mobile wallets to insure users' money.

Subsidised LED bulbs distributed in Nagaland

Nagaland State Department of Environment, Forests and Climate Change has taken up the initiative of providing subsidised LED bulbs to the residents of Nagaland villages, namely, Chingphoi, Changlang, Chingdang, Wanching, Wakching, Wakching Chingla, Namthai, Shiyong, Hotahoti, Kongan and Naginimora, under the Naginimora Forest Range, Mon Forest Division.

Sasken Communication Technologies announces corporate name change

Sasken Communication Technologies Ltd has changed its name to Sasken Technologies Ltd, to reflect its broad range of services. The change is effective from February 14, 2017.

The Bengaluru centre will have technical marketing and support teams, and specialised sales force that will focus on specific industry verticals like the IoT, medical electronics, aeronautics, automotive and R&D sector.

Apple to start manufacturing in India

Tech giant Apple has reached an agreement with Karnataka government to set up a manufacturing plant in Bengaluru. "Apple's decision on initial manufacturing in Bengaluru has further enhanced the reputation of Bengaluru as the most preferred destination for foreign investment," according to a press release by Karnataka government.

The release, signed by state IT minister Priyank Kharge, has mentioned that Apple's intentions to manufacture in Bengaluru "will foster a cutting-edge technology ecosystem and supply chain development in the state, which are critical for India to compete globally."

India will be the third country globally to assemble iPhones, an indication of how important the country has become for one of the world's most valued companies.

Corephotonics, Samsung Electro-Mechanics partner for smartphones

Corephotonics has partnered with camera module integrator Samsung Electro-Mechanics (SEMCO) to develop a complete reference design, based on its revolutionary dual-camera technology. Through this reference design, which is now in volume production, smartphone manufacturers will benefit from dramatic enhancements in image quality without any impact on the slim designs that consumers now expect from their handsets.

The partnership combines SEMCO's universally-recognised expertise in camera module design and manufacturing, with Corephotonics' innovative camera-related technologies. It enables a far greater number of smartphone manufacturers to access ground-breaking imaging technology that will help them to elevate user experience.

LED scheme triggers price battle in lighting industry

The government's LED distribution scheme has sparked a price war in the lighting industry. Domestic LED lamp manufacturers have alleged that some firms are indulging in monopolistic practices to bag government tenders at unviable prices, driving away competitors.

The latest tender by EESL, the nodal agency for LED lamp procurement, seeking 50 million lamps has received interest from 11 companies including Philips Lighting, Crompton Greaves and Surya Roshni. EESL had first purchased the LEDs at ₹ 310 per piece in 2014. The sales figure of LED lamps sold by EESL has crossed 200 million, while the industry is expected to have sold over 260 million LED lamps till December 2016.

Tata Motors, Microsoft partner for enhanced in-car connectivity

Tata Motors and Microsoft have announced a strategic agreement aimed at redefining the connected and personalised driving experience for Indian passenger vehicle buyers. The partnership announcement comes after Tata Motors revealed its new passenger vehicle strategy and TAMO sub-brand on February 2.

Tata Motors will leverage Microsoft's connected vehicle technologies that bring together artificial intelligence, advanced machine learning and the Internet of Things (IoT) capabilities on the global hyper-scale Azure Cloud. This will help create a highly-personalised, smart and safer driving experience across digital and physical worlds.

The Futuro concept car, billed as the first product from the TAMO initiative, will utilise Microsoft-enabled functionalities like advanced navigation, predictive maintenance, telematics and remote monitoring features.